

Advanced Water Safety — Assessment Rubric

Health & Physical Education · Year 9–10 · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0

STUDENT NAME	CLASS	TEACHER	ASSESSMENT OPTION (CIRCLE)	DUE DATE
			A — Policy Brief B — Campaign C — School Audit	

How to use this rubric

Read each criterion row carefully. Before submitting your work, complete the *Student Self-Assessment* column honestly — circle the grade descriptor that best matches your work. Your teacher will independently complete their assessment. Differences between your self-assessment and teacher assessment are a great starting point for feedback conversations.

What the grades mean

- A — Extending:**
Sophisticated, evidence-rich, insightful analysis.
- B — Building:**
Accurate, well-supported, clearly argued.
- C — Consolidating:**
Sound understanding, reasonable evidence.
- D — Developing:**
Partial understanding, limited evidence.
- E — Emerging:**
Beginning to engage with the concepts.

Grade scale: **E — Emerging** **D — Developing** **C — Consolidating** **B — Building** **A — Extending**

Criterion & Curriculum Code	E — Emerging	D — Developing	C — Consolidating	B — Building	A — Extending	Student Self-Assessment Complete before submitting
1. Data Analysis & Calculation VC2HP10P08	Cannot perform basic drowning rate calculations; misinterprets or ignores data.	Attempts calculations with errors; provides a simple description of data without interpretation.	Correctly calculates at least one rate; provides a reasonable, if brief, interpretation linking figures to context.	Accurate calculations with working shown; interprets significance and compares across contexts (e.g. Victoria vs national	Sophisticated calculations; nuanced interpretation; identifies implications and limitations of the data; draws	<i>I think I am at:</i> E — Emerging D — Developing C — Consolidating B — Building

Criterion & Curriculum Code	E — Emerging	D — Developing	C — Consolidating	B — Building	A — Extending	Student Self-Assessment Complete before submitting
				vs global); identifies key trends.	connections to other unit content.	☐ A — Extending
2. Physiological Knowledge VC2HP10P08 · VC2HP10M01	Cannot describe drowning physiology; vocabulary absent or significantly incorrect.	Names some physiological processes but cannot explain the mechanisms behind them.	Describes the drowning sequence in the correct order; uses most of the required vocabulary terms correctly.	Explains mechanisms precisely (not just names them); connects physiology to the CPR rationale and survival outcomes in a logical chain.	Sophisticated, accurate physiological analysis; all specified terms used correctly in context; explains clinical implications including the 4-minute window and secondary drowning.	<i>I think I am at:</i> ☐ E — Emerging ☐ D — Developing ☐ C — Consolidating ☐ B — Building ☐ A — Extending
3. Social Determinants Analysis VC2HP10P02	Identifies individuals as solely responsible; no systemic analysis present; relies on stereotypes.	Acknowledges that social factors exist; limited or superficial analysis of how they work.	Identifies key social determinants (e.g. gender norms, CALD background, SES); explains how they increase risk with reference to Victorian data.	Analyses multiple determinants with specific evidence; distinguishes structural from individual causes; proposes targeted strategies linked to specific mechanisms.	Sophisticated structural analysis; clearly distinguishes individual vs systemic causes; proposes evidence-based, equitable interventions; acknowledges complexity and intersectionality.	<i>I think I am at:</i> ☐ E — Emerging ☐ D — Developing ☐ C — Consolidating ☐ B — Building ☐ A — Extending
4. Prevention Strategy Evaluation VC2HP10P08 · VC2HP10P09	Cannot distinguish stronger from weaker prevention evidence; describes strategies without evaluating them.	Names prevention strategies; evaluates them superficially without using evidence or criteria.	Evaluates at least two strategies with reference to evidence; identifies at least one limitation for each; shows awareness of trade-offs.	Comparative evaluation using an evidence hierarchy; explicitly justifies resource allocation decisions; references specific studies or data sources.	Critical, nuanced evaluation; acknowledges trade-offs and context-dependence; sophisticated prioritisation with specific, well-justified reasoning and primary source citations.	<i>I think I am at:</i> ☐ E — Emerging ☐ D — Developing ☐ C — Consolidating ☐ B — Building ☐ A — Extending

Criterion & Curriculum Code	E — Emerging	D — Developing	C — Consolidating	B — Building	A — Extending	Student Self-Assessment Complete before submitting
5. International Comparison VC2HP10P09	No evidence of research; cannot identify or describe any international approaches.	Names one international organisation; provides a superficial, mostly descriptive account.	Compares at least two international approaches against Victorian practice; identifies at least one substantive difference.	Identifies substantive differences and similarities; evaluates the relevance of international approaches to the Victorian context with specific reasoning.	Critical, evidence-based comparison drawing on primary sources; argues specifically for or against adoption of international elements in Victoria; acknowledges contextual factors.	<i>I think I am at:</i> ☐ E — Emerging ☐ D — Developing ☐ C — Consolidating ☐ B — Building ☐ A — Extending
6. Communication Product VC2HP10P08	Incomplete; no clear audience, no evidence, no call to action or recommendation.	Basic message present; audience vague; one loosely cited fact; call to action generic.	Clear message; appropriate audience; at least one data-backed claim with source URL; specific call to action or recommendation.	Compelling product; evidence-based claims throughout; language clearly tailored to the named audience; measurable and realistic outcomes proposed.	Sophisticated, persuasive, evidence-rich product demonstrating advanced health literacy; addresses specific barriers for the target group; measurable outcomes; primary source citations throughout.	<i>I think I am at:</i> ☐ E — Emerging ☐ D — Developing ☐ C — Consolidating ☐ B — Building ☐ A — Extending
6. Diving & Spinal Injury Analysis VC2HP10P02 · VC2HP10P08	Cannot identify the mechanism of diving-related spinal injury; confuses swimming ability with injury prevention.	Identifies that diving can cause spinal injury; cites one statistic with a source; limited explanation of why the injury occurs.	Explains the cervical spine mechanism accurately; cites at least two AIHW/RLSSA statistics; provides a reasonable case study analysis identifying one common factor.	Accurate physiological explanation; two or more statistics cited with sources; case study analysis identifies common factors across all three incidents and explains the specific mechanism — not just the behaviour — in each.	Sophisticated analysis; structural explanation for the 95% male statistic using social determinants; distinguishes individual from structural causes; explains why inland waterway diving risk compounds with remote rescue delay and alcohol/group	<i>I think I am at:</i> ☐ E — Emerging ☐ D — Developing ☐ C — Consolidating ☐ B — Building ☐ A — Extending

Criterion & Curriculum Code	E — Emerging	D — Developing	C — Consolidating	B — Building	A — Extending	Student Self-Assessment Complete before submitting
					dynamics; evaluates the "Feet First" prevention message against evidence; proposes a complementary strategy for a named high-risk group with a SMART metric. Accurately deploys terms including quadriplegia, cervical spine, and false confidence.	

STUDENT SELF-ASSESSED
OVERALL GRADE



STUDENT: ONE THING I AM MOST PROUD OF IN THIS
ASSESSMENT

STUDENT: ONE THING I WOULD IMPROVE IF I HAD
MORE TIME

TEACHER: STRENGTHS

TEACHER: AREAS FOR DEVELOPMENT

TEACHER OVERALL GRADE AWARDED



TEACHER SIGNATURE & DATE

STUDENT SIGNATURE (ACKNOWLEDGES FEEDBACK
RECEIVED)

© **2026 Emilie Harrison.** This resource is licensed under [Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International \(CC BY 4.0\)](https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). You are free to copy, share, adapt and build on it — including for commercial purposes — provided you give appropriate credit and indicate any changes.

Suggested attribution: “Swim & Water Safety Teaching Hub” by Emilie Harrison, licensed CC BY 4.0. Source: emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety

Third-party material is not covered. Content owned by Life Saving Victoria, Royal Life Saving Australia, Surf Life Saving Australia, VCAA, ACARA, AIATSIS, the Australian Resuscitation Council and other organisations — including data, guidelines, logos and program names — remains the property of those owners and is used here for educational purposes. Check directly with the owner before reproducing it elsewhere.

Data sources cited in this resource. Drowning statistics are reproduced with attribution from: Life Saving Victoria. (2025). *Victorian Drowning Report 2024–25*. Life Saving Victoria: Melbourne. Royal Life Saving Australia (2026). *National Drowning Report 2026*. RLSSA: Sydney. Royal Life Saving Australia (2025). *National Drowning Report 2025*. RLSSA: Sydney. World Health Organization (2024). *Drowning — fact sheet*. WHO: Geneva. Surf Life Saving Australia (2026). *Summer Coastal Drowning Report 2025/26*. SLISA: Sydney. These figures remain the property of the publishing organisations. If you adapt this resource, retain these citations.